

SERVICE ANIMAL ACCESS NOTICE

To Business Owners, Managers, and Security Personnel:

This dog, **[Insert Name of Dog/Animal Here]**, is a legally recognized Service Animal under the **Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act (AODA)** and the **Ontario Human Rights Code (OHRC)**.

Under provincial law, **obligated organizations (O. Reg. 165/16 s. 80.45 (2))** are required to allow persons with disabilities to be accompanied by their Service Animal in all areas open to the public. A Medical Letter from a **Regulated Health Professional (O. Reg. 165/16 s. 80.45 (4)b)** is the official documentation that satisfies this legal requirement.

Summary of Ontario Legal Framework:

- **Identification & Documentation:** Service animals are **not** legally required to wear a vest or harness. Under **O. Reg. 165/16, s. 80.45 (4)a**, a Medical Letter from a Regulated Health Professional is the definitive and sole proof required.
- **General Public Access:** Per **O. Reg. 165/16, s. 80.47 (2)**, obligated organizations shall ensure that a person with a disability is permitted to enter the premises with their service animal and keep the animal with them.
- **Food Establishments:** Under the ***Health Protection and Promotion Act* (O. Reg. 493/17, s. 14)**, service animals are expressly exempt from rules prohibiting animals in areas where food is served, sold, or offered for sale.
- **Privacy Rights:** The ***Ontario Human Rights Code*** prohibits businesses from demanding disclosure of a person's medical diagnosis or proof of the animal's training. (*Allarie v. Rouble*, 2010 HRTO 61).

Thank you for ensuring your staff is aware of these guidelines **(O. Reg. 165/16 s. 80.49 (1))** to maintain compliance with Ontario's accessibility and human rights laws.